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For years past it has been our custom to have

A Great Clearing Sale

In February. This is no exception. The sale this month, however, is doubly interesting, as we have the **ENTIRE STOCK OF MANGUM & MONTGOMERY**, bought at such figures that enable us to offer such assortments and to name such prices that are **Paralyzing to Competition!**

But Delightful to Customers.

NOTE A FEW PRICES PICKED UP HERE AND THERE:

Dress Goods

Again to the front! Unstring your purses and go freely to the dress goods counters of B. C. E. Co. and reap the benefit of a low purchase.

25 pieces assorted styles dress goods, M. & M. price, 10c; our price, 7c.

20 pieces assorted styles and patterns, M. & M. price, 20c; our price, 12c.

35 pieces choice goods and a general favorite with M. & M. at 25c; our price 15c.

A combination lot of plain, fancy, plaids, checks and stripes, very popular with M. & M. at 30c; our price, 20c.

Double fold hair-line stripes, M. & M. price, 60c; we are closing at 45c.

All wool camel's hair, full 50 inches

wide, in plain and fancy to match, M. & M. price, \$1; we make the price 50c.

Combination Suits

No other store begins to offer such assortments or can name such prices; suits sold by M. & M. at \$17.50 we now offer at \$10.

DOMESTICS.

This house has enjoyed the pre-eminent position for years of being by far the largest retailers of Cotton Goods in this city. Never before has it been more entitled to that distinguished position than it is to-day. Prices fully 25 to 33 1-3 per cent. below the sharpest competition.

Corsets

For the corsetless and everybody else. NOTE—A splendid long-waisted corset, with side steels, M. & M. driving price, 50c; we make the price 25c.

An elegant corset, nicely finished, and sold by M. & M. as a leader at 85c; we have placed them on our counter at 50c. Our \$1 corset leads the world. See them.

GENTS' FURNISHING GOODS.

The prices we have made on M. & M.'s furnishing goods for men and boys are too low to be met by dealers, but in the reach of all customers. See the wonderful bargains we are offering in this department.

STATE AFFAIRS.

The Substitute for the Anti-Strike Bill is Discussed at Great Length by the Senate.

The House Bill to Permit Defendants to Testify in Their Own Behalf Amended to Death.

Professor Hogg Delivers a Lecture in the Hall of the Representatives—Another New County Bill.

SHALL DEFENDANTS TESTIFY? Special to the Gazette.

AUSTIN, Feb. 14.—The bill to permit defendants to testify in their own behalf in criminal cases came up on its final passage before the House this morning. The members testified to the importance of the measure by entering into an elaborate and pointed discussion that occupied the greater portion of the morning session. Mr. Browning opposed its passage because it invited perjury. He said that in civil cases where money matters were involved it was common for those interested to contort the truth, and how much more would be the inducement in criminal cases where a man's life and liberty were at stake. He thought there was more justice in the old common law that did not even allow those related by blood or marriage to testify in behalf of defendants.

Mr. Moore of Travis also opposed the passage of the bill on similar grounds with Mr. Browning. He cited instances where defendants might, by taking advantage of the privilege to testify in their own behalf, commit perjury and defeat justice.

Mr. Payne favored its passage because he believed that Texas ought not to be so far behind other states in the administration of justice. He thought under the law allowing juries to be the judges of the credibility of the witnesses there would be an ample safe-guard against any abuse of the privilege granted the defendant.

Mr. Shield opposed the bill because he believed if a man would steal and commit murder he would also, if given a chance to swear in his own behalf, defeat the force of any circumstantial evidence that might be offered to convict him.

Mr. Williamson moved to amend by striking out "competent witness" and insert the words "to allow the defendant to make his own sworn statements." He thought both sides of the case ought to be heard where a man was accused of a crime by force of circumstances, and perhaps the only witness of the supposed crime, and if given a chance, be able to explain his innocence as a creditable man.

Mr. Robinson favored the amendment on the ground that defendants should be allowed to make statements to the jury to go for what they were worth.

Mr. Latimer opposed the amendment because it would destroy the effect of the bill, and in support of his position related an incident in his own experience where he paid a fine for an assault that he never committed.

Mr. Groce favored the amendment and the bill because he looked on it as a measure to encourage the crime of perjury, and ought to be so entitled in the caption of the bill.

Mr. Northington moved the previous question on the amendment and the bill, but the motion was lost.

Mr. Cone then spoke in favor of the amendment and the bill, quoting from the Bible in support of his argument why a defendant should be allowed to make his statement.

Mr. Browning then offered a substitute for the amendment that the defendant be permitted to make his voluntary statement before the taking of testimony, and not afterwards. Mr. Browning said that if he made his statement before the testimony was taken he might tell the truth, but if he was permitted to hear the witnesses first he could then invent a story to defeat justice.

Mr. Bell of Cook was opposed to the bill with or without amendments, because he thought that it would not be equal justice to the defendants themselves; that some men, by reason of their advantages and shrewdness could go on the stand and invent a plausible version of their innocence, while a poor, ignorant fellow, however innocent, could be tangled up on cross examination so as to throw suspicion on his testimony that would lead to his conviction. He believed the doctrine of reasonable doubt and the advantages over the state in challenging the jurors was an ample protection.

Mr. Robinson then offered a substitute to strike out "by his own request" and insert "by permission of the court" to make his statement to the jury. Explaining the object of his amendment Mr. Robinson said it would give no advantage to a guilty man and would allow an innocent man a chance to explain.

Mr. Hudgins said he thought since Mr. Browning's amendment had been tacked on to the bill that it virtually killed it, and he moved to lay the bill and all the amendments on the table. The motion was carried, and thus ended by far the most interesting debate in the House this session, occupying almost the entire time of the House up to adjournment.

ANTI-STRIKE BILL.

The substitute for what is known as the anti-strike bill in the Senate, requiring railroads to give their employees thirty days notice before making any reduction of wages, came up in the Senate and after occupying the entire morning session was the pending business when that body adjourned. Senators Harrison, Bell, Te. rel, Houston, Pope, Burney and Allen took prominent parts in the prolonged discussion which at times grew both warm and eloquent. The original bill required railroads to give employees notice of

thirty days before reduction or discharge and also employees were required to give railroads thirty days notice before going on a strike. The substitute eliminates the clause referring to the employees giving notice to railroads and is only binding on the roads to give notice of any reduction of wages. An amendment was pending to extend the provisions of the bill to include all corporations which was voted down just before adjournment.

PROFESSOR HOGG'S LECTURE.

Professor Hogg of Fort Worth delivered an able lecture in the hall of Representatives to-night. Speaking of the time when he went to Fort Worth in 1882, he said that the tax was only one-fourth of 1 per cent. for school purposes. On one occasion he said that the whole-souled liberality of Peter Smith caused him to exclaim that if this tax was not sufficient to school the children, to tax him (Peter Smith) 5 per cent. rather than the school should fail. This was the liberal spirit he desired to see manifested all over this grand empire state. On the matter of providing county superintendents he appealed to Speaker Pendleton and other members and Senators present that they prepare and pass some kind of a bill that would give the counties a right to have competent county superintendents. He thought there were good teachers all over that would make excellent material to fill these places. The Superintendent of Public Instruction ought to be informed once every month of the condition of the schools throughout the state, but this was impossible under the present system of placing the control in the hands of the county judges. The system of supervising the schools had proved a success in Germany and other countries, and also in our cities. Then why would it not prove beneficial to the state of Texas? The Professor dealt in figures and facts, making an elaborate and interesting showing of the present school system, and its need of legislative aid to make it equal to other states of the Union. At the conclusion of his lecture he was congratulated by many present for his clear and logical manner of treating the subject.

ANOTHER NEW COUNTY.

Senator Houston will introduce a bill to create a new county by cutting off a slice each from Milam, Bell, Williamson, Travis and Bastrop.

GALVESTON.

The Medical College Move Taken in Hand. Theatrical. Special to the Gazette.

GALVESTON, TEX., Feb. 14.—At a special meeting of the City Council this evening it was voted unanimously that an ordinance should be introduced and adopted at the next regular meeting relating to the state for the purpose of erecting a medical college thereon one-half of the valuable block of ground situated in the east end of the city, now occupied by the public school, the other half to be utilized for the Sealy hospital, the erection of which is provided for by the munificent donation of \$50,000 from the estate of the late John Sealy. The Mayor has appointed a committee to go to Austin and labor with the legislature in the matter of appropriating money to carry on a medical college.

The famous comedians Robson and Crane made their appearance before a Texas audience to-night at the Tremont opera house in that most humorous of Shakespearean plays, The Comedy of Errors. The house was crowded from pit to dome, standing room being at a premium.

LONGVIEW.

A Rabid Dog's Work—The First Since Last May. Special to the Gazette.

LONGVIEW, TEX., Feb. 14.—A large dog which had been acting strangely for the past week suddenly began to froth at the mouth and snap and snarl, and, breaking into the street, leaped upon F. T. Rembert, tearing with his teeth a strip from his overcoat extending from near the shoulder its entire length. Leaving him, it struck its teeth into a cow standing near, and it is thought also bit a dog. In less time than it takes to tell it the streets and alleys near by were thronged with men, who brought the poor brute down after thirty-six shots had been fired into him.

A slow rain has been falling at intervals for about a week. This was getting to be an absolute necessity, as there has been no rain of much benefit since last May, and wells were fast becoming useless. A large amount of water has fallen and, coming slowly, has soaked into the ground.

FORT SMITH.

A Territory Man Resists Arrest, Tries to Kill and is Wounded. Special to the Gazette.

FORT SMITH, ARK., Feb. 14.—Deputy United States Marshal James Pelly came to-day with Frank Crutchfield, who will have to answer two charges of assault with intent to kill, resisting process and peddling whisky in the Indian Territory. Crutchfield was arrested some days ago by Deputy Marshal Hughes, but made his escape. On Wednesday night last at the McAllister coal mines he was severely wounded in the shoulder by Joe Nail, Sheriff of Polk county, Co. law nation whom he attacked with a gun. He was soon afterward arrested at his home by Pelly, being too badly wounded to make any resistance. His wound is quite serious and he is suffering greatly with it. It is reported that Crutchfield is a refugee from justice from Tennessee, where he is wanted for engaging in klu-kluxing, or something of that sort.

A Petition.

Special to the Gazette. WILLS POINT, TEX., Feb. 14.—A numerous signed memorial will be forwarded to Honorable John T. Curry of Van Zandt, by his constituency in a few days, urging him to use his utmost endeavors favoring the passage of Senator Field's (of Robertson county) bill to regulate the hiring of convicts out of the penitentiary, and prevent the massing of large numbers in any one place.

LANHAM'S FIELD DAY.

Lanham's Trade Dollar Bill is Substituted for the Senate Bill and Passed by House.

The Senatorial Investigation Into the Alleged Washington County Outrages to Begin To-day.

The Texas Delegation Unite on Maxey for a Position on the Inter-State Commerce Commission.

LANHAM'S VICTORY.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—Mr. Lanham secured a triumph in the House on Saturday by the adoption of his substitute trade-dollar bill for the bill as it passed the Senate, and in the face of the recommendation of the majority of the House coinage committee. The Senate bill provided that the coin redeemed should be treated as silver bullion, and the amount be deducted from the monthly purchase of bullion for coinage into standard silver dollars under the existing law, thereby preventing any increase of the silver circulation. The position taken by the minority of the committee, led by Mr. Lanham, is that the trade dollar now having no legal tender value, shall be recoined and remonetized, immediately of the state requiring the monthly coinage of standard dollars, thus adding to the circulation whatever amount of the repudiated coin may be presented for redemption. The Lanham amendment fixes six months as the time in which redemption may be made, and provides that the holders of trade dollars shall receive the standard in exchange for them on presentation, dollar for dollar, and that the coin thus redeemed shall be sent to the mints and re-coined into standard dollars at the expense of the United States. The Warner amendment clinches the whole business by providing that the recoinage shall not be counted as part of the silver bullion required to be purchased and coined under the act of 1875. Mr. Lanham has given great attention to the silver question, and especially to the measure of which he is the father, and which has just passed the House. He has made many speeches in the House on the free coinage of silver, and the one delivered by him last session was scattered broadcast throughout the country, so great was the demand for it. The passage of Lanham's amendment shows the influence of the friends of silver money in the House, and was a complete knock-down for the House committee. It was a field day for Mr. Lanham, and will greatly increase his influence both here and at home. He has been the recipient of wide and genuine congratulations on all sides. Whether the Senate will accept the House substitute and thus end the matter remains to be seen, but it is probable it will yield its point of difference and finally dispose of this troublesome question.

COKE'S MEMORIAL.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—The memorial presented by Senator Coke to-day relative to the alleged political outrages in Texas declared that the charges made by Hackworth, Moore and Schmitz are general in their nature and wholly destitute of truth, and there was no conspiracy to hang negroes, usurp the officers or to banish them from Washington county. The memorial further declares that the petitioners named above are men of high repute, and specially states that Hackworth mismanaged county affairs while in office. The senate committee formed to investigate the above subject will begin its labors to-morrow.

MAXEY AS COMMISSIONER.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—The Texas delegation has had several meetings since Judge Reagan's return here for the purpose of agreeing upon some person whom they could recommend to the President for a position on the inter-state commerce commission. The air has been full of straws as to the result of their deliberations, but so strong were the barriers behind which they were entrenched and so sacred were the vows of secrecy each member was obliged to swear to that it has been impossible to-day to obtain any definite information on the subject. Your correspondent learns to-night, however, on undoubted authority that the delegation have finally determined on their nomination. Only three names were before them, viz: Senator Maxey, Congressman Mills and Representative Jones. After several meetings Senator Maxey was finally chosen, and Judge Reagan made a most felicitous speech for his defeated friend. The matter is now definitely settled, and the delegation have submitted their recommendation to the President. What he may do only the Infinite can tell, yet the feeling here is quite general that Texas will not be represented on the commission and that Maxey has no chance.

TEXAS NOTES.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—Thirty or forty of the witnesses who have been summoned to appear before the Senate committee on privileges and elections are in the city. The investigation will begin to-morrow morning. Ex-Governor Ireland will arrive here to-night with about twenty-five other witnesses.

In the Senate to-day Senator Coke presented petition of citizens of Washington county, asking that the investigation already ordered be held in that county, where the facts could be more readily obtained.

Mr. Wellborn left for home last night to argue an important case in the courts. Congressman Throckmorton left for McKinney to-night and will not return here this session.

WASHINGTON NOTES.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—Thomas B. Connery of New York, was to-day confirmed to be Secretary of Legation at the City of Mexico.

Colonel John Jameson, general superintendent of the railway mail service, has resigned, and Nash, chief clerk of the Postoffice Department, has been appointed to fill the vacancy.

B. C. EVANS CO.

Fort Worth, Texas.

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CONGRESSIONAL.

The Senate Debates the Steel Ship Bill.
With Pungent Remarks by Senator Riddleberger.

The House Devotes Its Time to Discussion of Fine Points of Order of Importance.

XLIX CONGRESS.

THE SENATE.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—The House amendment to the Senate bill for the relief of Albert H. Emery, reducing the appropriation from \$200,000 to \$65,161 and declaring that to be full payment of all claims against the government on the part of Emery for his invention of a testing machine built for the United States, was non-concurred in and a conference committee ordered.

Sensor Coke presented a memorial from citizens of Washington county, Tex., asking that the investigation of charges recently made against the citizens and authorities of that county be carried on at Brenham, Tex., where all the witnesses, books, papers and records are to be found. Referred to the committee on privileges and elections.

Sensor Hale presented a protest of the Speedansta Club against the ratification of an extradition treaty with Great Britain. Referred to the committee on foreign relations.

On motion of Senator Eatis the House bill to confirm to Emile Gaurin and Cheri P. Mannor title to certain lands on False river, Point Coupe, La., was taken up, and after some discussion laid aside without action.

Sensor George presented the petition of some colored men in Mississippi asking the appropriation of \$100 a piece to transport them to Siberia. Referred to the committee on education and labor.

The petition which was read assigns as a reason for the proposed emigration, "low wages, high rents and despair of doing better." As to the supposition that "their labor and votes are required here," the petitioners say "the country can very well dispense with their presence." Sensor George called attention to the fact that the body of the petition was printed and suggested that it emanated from a source from which many petitions came to Congress.

Sensor Allison offered a resolution which was adopted, requesting the President to have search made in the records of the War, State and Treasury Departments for information as to the services rendered by Count Casimir Pulaski, Brigadier-General of the United States Army in 1777-89, and till he was killed in action, and as to any payment or compensation paid to him for his services; also as to any just and proper indebtedness of the United States to General Pulaski on account of his expenses for military supplies furnished for troops in his command, and especially as to 100,000 gold dollars or other sum of money transmitted by Count Pulaski's friends in Europe, and which arrived at the time he was killed in battle at Savannah; whether such funds went into the public Treasury or were used by the authorities of the Continental Congress or by the authorities of the state of Georgia for the benefit of the United States.

Sensor Cullom offered a resolution calling upon the Secretary of War for information as to whether any unusual necessity existed for requiring some of the clerks in the Adjutant General's and Surgeon-General's offices to work after hours. After a brief discussion the resolution went over until to-morrow.

Sensor Dawes referred to the fact that at the last session a communication from the Treasury Department as to the exportation and reimportation of distilled spirits, had been referred to the committee on finance, and he inquired whether there was a prospect of the committee reporting at this session.

Sensor Morrill, chairman of the committee on finance, replied that a subcommittee had been appointed to consider the subject and had not yet reported to the full committee. He would call attention to the matter at the committee meeting to-morrow.

Sensor Gibson offered a resolution, which was adopted, requesting the President to furnish copies of all correspondence relating to the arrest, trial and discharge of A. K. Cutting, a United States citizen, by the authorities of Mexico.

Sensor Ingalls inquired whether an answer had been received to the Senate resolution calling for the correspondence between the State Department and Minister Jackson.

The presiding officer replied that no answer had been received.

On motion of Senator Cameron the Senate took up for consideration—yeas 37, nays 17—the bill introduced and reported by him "to increase the naval establishment."

The Senators voting against taking it up were Beck, Call, Cockrell, Coke, George, Jones of Arkansas, Maxey, Plumb, Pugh, Ransom, Sherman, Vance, VanWyck, Vest, Voorhees, Walthall and Wilson of Maryland.

Sensor Cameron addressed the Senate in advocacy of the bill. We should, he said, commence at once to build ten first-class protected steel cruisers provided for in the bill.

On motion of Senator Hawley an amendment was added to the second section in these words, "Save that in all their parts they shall be of American manufacture."

On motion of Senator Morgan a section was added requiring the construction of three of the vessels on the Pacific coast, three on the Gulf of Mexico and four on the Atlantic coast.

Sensor Van Wyck inquired whether a provision was made in the bill for war vessels on the lakes.

Sensor Hale, chairman of the committee on naval affairs, replied that the committee had a bill pending, a measure which he would call up at an early day which covered the features of floating batteries on rafts for harbor defenses,

torpedo boats and torpedo appliances and also of light draught gunboats for use on the western lakes.

Sensor Butler, a member of the committee on naval affairs, suggested to Senator Hale that he would be safe in adding that both bills (Cameron and Hale's) had the unanimous sanction of the committee on naval affairs.

Sensor Van Wyck made a calculation as to the aggregate amount appropriated in these bills and in the two ordinance bills recently passed and said it would reach \$71,000,000.

Sensor Hale said even if they did this expenditure would range through a period of from three to six years, and, therefore, would only interfere to that extent with the treasury surplus.

Sensor Van Wyck regarded that surplus as "problematical." It was extremely doubtful whether there would be any surplus for the coming year. He agreed, however, with the remark made by the Senator from Kansas (Plumb) that there was no danger of that bill becoming a law. He presumed it was not introduced and reported with the expectation, hope or desire that it would become a law. The people were not complaining of their being a few dollars in the treasury, but they were complaining of high taxes. The object of this bill was to give an excuse for not reducing taxation. The object was to draw empty the treasury, so as to be able to say that the taxes could not be reduced, and when pen-pens were asked for disabled soldiers, they would be told that they could not be released because there was no money in the treasury. Men were more valuable than steel ships and fortifications. They would have to be niggardly in paying men who had offered their bodies as bulwarks against those who sought to take the life of the nation, because foresight there would be no money in the Treasury to pay them. He believed the best way to make provision for the next war would be the generous prodigality, liberality or rather honesty of the government towards its defenders.

Sensor Riddleberger, a member of the committee on naval affairs, said he might be classified as one of those who had sought to take the life of the nation, but now, since it had become a nation, he was willing to vote money to maintain it as a nation. He would not give one southern man who was to-day in favor of a United States navy for all the brigadier-generals of the Union army who were opposed to it.

At 2 o'clock the presiding officer laid before the Senate undrilled business, it being the Eads Tehuantepec bill.

Sensor Cameron moved to postpone the bill till to-morrow, so as to go on with the naval bill. The motion was defeated, yeas 24, nays 28, as follows:

Yeas—Aldrich, Blackburn, Bowen, Butler, Cameron, Cheney, Dawes, Farwell, Frye, Hale, Hawley, McMillan, Mahone, Manderson, Miller, Morgan, Platt, Pugh, Riddleberger, Sawyer, Spooner, Teller, Williams and Wilson of Iowa.

Nays—Allison, Beck, Berry, Call, Cockrell, Coke, Conger, Cullom, Enstis, Fair, George, Gorham, Hampton, Harris, Ingalls, Maxey, Mitchell of Oregon, Payne, Plumb, Ransom, Saulsbury, Vance, VanWyck, Vest, Voorhees, Walthall, Whitthorne and Wilson of Maryland—28.

Sensor Riddleberger observed as a parting salute to the naval bill that the vote just taken was to show that the American Senate preferred to take up the Eads ship railroad to doing that which American sentiment demanded, the reconstruction of the navy.

The naval bill was laid aside.

Sensor Dolph from the conference committee on the Senate bill restoring to the United States certain lands granted to the Northern Pacific Railway Company, reported the committee had been unable to agree.

Sensor Plumb inquired as to the cause of the seemingly great delay in making a conference report.

Sensor Dolph thought the inquiry a pertinent one, and he sent to the clerk's desk and had read a letter written to-day by the Senate conferees to the House conferees, of which the following is an extract: "Since then (February 4) we have heard nothing officially or unofficially concerning the matter although we immediately renewed our request for possession of the bill so as to enable us to submit a conference report in the Senate. We cannot comprehend the cause of delay as we do not understand there is any difference of opinion between the managers on the part of the House as to what shall be done to secure a submission of the conference report. If there is any difference of opinion upon this point please inform us, if not kindly send the bill by bearer, the clerk of the committee on public lands, or adopt some other method of transmission as you are advised is proper." Sensor Plumb stated the reason why the delay was a proper subject of inquiry was all this time while the question was in suspense the Northern Pacific Railway Company was constructing additional sections of road and earning lands which it was the beneficent purpose of the bill to forfeit. He said at least a million acres of public lands had passed from under control of the United States and for that reason the question of delay was a very important one.

The report was adopted and a new conference ordered. Senators, Dolph, Teller and Cockrell being reappointed on the part of the Senate.

The Senate then resumed consideration of the Eads Tehuantepec bill, and Senator Morgan replied to some arguments made by Mr. Hoar on the subject last week. He expressed his belief that the proposed ship railway could never be of any use for the transportation of large vessels of war, because it was admitted it could not transport vessels of more than 6000 tons displacement loaded. Still he was willing to give this corporation a chance to go before the capitalists of the world and engage all the money it could get, but when the interests of the government had so got out of the way and be yielded up for the advantage of a private enterprise he did not propose to assent to it. He favored the Nicaraguan route for a canal.

Sensor Edmunds obtained the floor to make a speech on the bill but yielded for other business.

Sensor Riddleberger moved to go into executive session and said this was the seventh time within a few weeks he had made the motion in this "House of Lords" in order to take up some nominations that concerned his state, but he always met the opposition of the Senator from Vermont (Edmunds).

The motion was agreed to and the Senate went into secret session and soon adjourned.

THE HOUSE.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—Mr. Henderson of Iowa, called up the resolution offered by him Monday last, discharging the committee of the whole from further consideration of the Senate bill granting a pension to Mary S. Logan, and making that

the special order for to-morrow immediately after the reading of Journal.

Mr. Breckenridge of Kentucky, made a point of order that it was not competent for gentlemen to call up the resolution for action, but that it must be referred to the committee on rules.

Mr. Willis of Kentucky combatted this position. He had recently studied the rules in relation to another matter (the Blair educational bill) and he was thoroughly convinced that it was within the power of a member to offer a resolution to change the rules, let it lie over for one day and then call it up as a privileged question. The constitution gives the House power to amend the rules. If the Speaker ruled that every proposition to change the rules must be referred to the committee of rules, 332 members of the House would be under the control of the majority of a committee consisting of three men.

Mr. Henderson contended that even if the point of order had any merit it was presented too late, the proper time to have made the point was when the resolution was originally offered.

Mr. Mills of Texas thought if the position taken by the gentleman from Iowa (Henderson) was decided to be correct the whole machinery of the House would be revolutionized.

Mr. Henderson said that as to-day was devoted to business of the District of Columbia he would let the matter lie over until to-morrow immediately after the reading of the Journal.

The Speaker said that in view of previous decisions, the chair had little doubt as to the right of a member to give notice to change the rules, but the question upon which the chair had very grave doubts was as to the status of the matter when again called up. The chair would like to examine into that question. The matter was then laid over until to-morrow.

It was at the Speaker's suggestion that Henderson consented to postponement. The decision of the Speaker will be of importance owing to the fact that should the point of order be overruled the friends of the Blair educational bill will resort to the same method to secure a day for consideration of that measure.

Mr. Wise of Virginia, from the committee on naval affairs, reported a resolution calling on the Secretary of the Navy for information as to the number of persons employed at and discharged from the various navy yards between January 1st, 1886, and January 1st, 1887; also as to whether any orders had been issued for the transfer of plants and material from certain bureaus at the navy yards to certain other bureaus, whether it is designed to permanently discontinue the operation of any bureaus at any navy yards, and if so, by what authority and in pursuance of what policy of naval administration.

On motion of Mr. Randall the resolutions were laid on the table—135 to 115.

Mr. Willis of Kentucky, as a privileged question, offered a resolution discharging the committee on education from further consideration of the Blair educational bill and making that bill the continuing special order for February 19 and asked that it lie over for one day.

Mr. Springer of Illinois made the point of order that it was not in order to offer a resolution or if offered, it must be referred to the committee on rules.

The Speaker decided that under clause 1 of rule 28, a member had a right to give notice of a proposed amendment to the rules. The question as to what the status of the resolution would be when it was called up, the Chair did not decide. He would take the matter under advisement.

Mr. Springer protesting against the ruling, offered a resolution making the tariff bills the special order for Thursday night, when it shall be in order to consider the bill in the House and after thirty minutes debate the previous question shall be deemed as ordered, and the bill shall be put upon its passage, and but one dilatory motion shall be entertained until the question is put on the final passage of the bill.

Mr. Dingley of Maine made the point of order that the resolution was not a notice of change of rule and therefore could not be entertained.

The Speaker also took this question under advisement.

By Mr. Lawler of Illinois. Resolved, that the Secretary of State be requested to inform the House whether the terms of the treaty of Ghent by which peace was consummated between the United States and Great Britain in December, 1814, and ratified by the Senate in February, 1815, are construed to inhibit the United States from maintaining an effective navy on the northern lakes bordering the Dominion of Canada, and also whether the construction by Great Britain of the Welland canal is not in effect a violation of the treaty of Ghent, and in case of war with that country a menace to the safety of our lake-board cities.

By Mr. Morrow of California, amendment of the Chinese restrictive immigration act.

By Mr. King of Louisiana, to prohibit members of Congress from acting as attorney or employee in any case in which the government is interested.

By Mr. Cutcheon of Michigan, appointing a commission consisting of the Commissioner of Pensions, two Senators and two Representatives, to revise the pension laws and to report the result of its investigation to Congress.

By Mr. Skinner of North Carolina, a resolution making the bill repealing the tobacco tax a special order for February 19.

By Mr. Butterworth of Ohio, for full reciprocity between the United States and the Dominion of Canada.

By Mr. Little of Ohio, providing for a constitutional amendment for the election of Senators by the people of the several states.

By Mr. Weaver of Iowa, making the Oklahoma bill the special order for February 18.

The floor was then accorded to the committee on the District of Columbia, and the afternoon was spent in consideration of district bills upon the private calendar, but no final action was taken and the House took a recess, district business only to be considered at the evening session.

Notes from Gateville.

SPECIAL TO THE GAZETTE.

GATEVILLE, TEX., Feb. 14.—Sheriff Lonam has just returned from Waco, having in charge John C. Turner, wanted at this place for selling mortgaged property.

This section has lately been visited with fine rains, and prospects for grain crops are flattering.

Since the widening of the gauge of the St. Louis, Arkansas and Texas Railway the sound of the saw and hammer is continually heard in the city and everything is booming.

ON WALL STREET.

The Week on the Stock Exchange Opens with a Dull and Generally Featureless Market.

The Fluctuations in Railway Bonds Small and Unimportant—A Decrease in the Sales.

COMMERCIAL RESUME.

SPECIAL TO THE GAZETTE.

NEW YORK, Feb. 14.—Railway bonds today sold as follows: Texas and Pacific Rios at 70 1/2; St. Louis, Arkansas and Texas 2's at 54; Houston and Texas Central Railway 2's at 97 1/2; Gulf, Colorado and Santa Fe 1's at 121 1/2; Kansas and Texas 5's at 85 1/2; Missouri, Kansas and Texas 5's at 85 1/2; do 6's at 98 1/2.

Sterling fund. Money 3/4 at 44 per cent. Governments steady.

Oil closed at 62 1/2. Cotton weak. Coffee dull.

Wheat inactive.

GOVERNMENTS, STOCKS AND BONDS.

NEW YORK, Feb. 14.—The new week on the Stock Exchange opened with a dull and generally featureless market, the larger operators, in consequence of the uncertainties of the situation again holding off, while transactions were mainly left to professionals.

London was very quiet, some selling of Erie being the most important transactions by that interest for the day. Trading, while dull and with fluctuations confined to very narrow limits was somewhat feverish throughout the day. In the last hour there was a general selling movement induced by the bears ostensibly on advices of commercial trouble elsewhere.

The market was generally firm early in the day, but the preponderance of bear sentiment among the room traders later had the effect of sagging prices off slowly. The opening was about steady, the first prices showing only insignificant changes from Saturday's closing figures.

The market was dull, prices were firm and fractional advances were made within the first hour under the lead of Louisville and Nashville. The list then became generally heavy and slowly yielded until near 1 p. m., when the market responded to the extraordinary strength in Richmond and West Point, and in most cases the early losses were regained.

The last hour saw a decided break upon more active business and the close was weak at the lowest figures of the day. The majority of the active list is invariably lower. Lackawanna, Omaha and Texas and Pacific are down 1 each.

Railroad bonds dull; sales \$855,000. The fluctuations were small and unimportant.

Government bonds were dull and steady.

A HEAVY FAILURE.

One of the Oldest Business Houses of Galveston in Trouble.

SPECIAL TO THE GAZETTE.

GALVESTON, TEX., Feb. 14.—About 10 o'clock to-night rumors began to fly about town that the old and well known wholesale dry goods firm of Block, Oppenheimer & Co. had made an assignment to Albert Weiss for the benefit of its creditors.

A reporter immediately visited the office of the firm and found attorneys and others present as though just concluding some important conference. The assignment was denied but it was admitted that the firm was embarrassed and the statement was made that the nature and extent of its embarrassment would be made public to-morrow. From all that can be learned to-night from reliable sources there is no doubt whatever but that an assignment has been determined upon if not already consummated.

The failure caused general surprise to-night wherever known. The firm has been in business in this city for the past twenty years. For several years its title was Greenlee, Block & Co., but three years ago Mr. Greenlee withdrew. The firm did a large business, handling boots and shoes in addition to dry goods. No particulars regarding the liabilities or assets could be obtained to-night.

A FEMALE TOTER.

In Taking Her Gun Off It Falls and She Is Shot.

SPECIAL TO THE GAZETTE.

HOUSTON, TEX., Feb. 14.—Essie Taylor, a fallen woman, living at Nellie Cook's bungalow, on Smith street, was accidentally shot to-night at 11:30 o'clock, and is now believed to be dying from the effects of the wound. The facts of the case are as follows: The girl was in the habit of wearing a pistol and had one on her person this evening, and in attempting to lay it on her bureau before retiring it dropped on the floor causing it to be discharged, the ball striking her in the left groin, ranging upward and making its exit near the spinal column. Dr. McDonald was called and said her chances for recovery were doubtful. The girl has only been in Houston about ten days, and is said to hail from Lake Charles, La.

Congress Will Be Deloged.

MADISON, WIS., Feb. 14.—The following circular was issued to-day from the national headquarters of the Grand Army of the Republic, signed by Commander-in-Chief Fairchild: "In view of the recent veto of dependent pension bill and the very great importance of that measure to the army of our disabled comrades who need and are justly entitled to help, it is recommended that posts and comrades everywhere, by resolutions and letters, inform the members of Congress, who are entitled to and will gladly receive these expressions of opinion, their approval or disapproval of the principles involved in the vetoed bill."

St. Jacobs Oil is excellent for swellings, bruises, etc., says Mr. Buchter, Lancaster, Pa.

A Queer Story.

MINNEAPOLIS TRIBUNE.

I heard a queer fact to-day that seems to come fittingly under this head of mind-reading. Last fall there was a company of Zunis stopping in and around Boston. The Zunis showed great admiration and fondness for the sea, and one day of their visit was passed in an excursion to Manchester, on the coast, a few miles from Boston. While there the old chief Pa-lo-wah-te-wa broke out with the exclamation, "the old man died last night," referring to one of the patriarchs of the tribe in Zuniland, whose illness had occupied the minds of his brethren for some time before. This remark was

jotted in the memorandum book of a newspaper man who overheard it, and thought it might be worth remembering.

This newspaper man has received a letter from Mr. Frank Cushing, the young ethnologist who was instrumental in bringing the Zunis here. He wrote that "the old man" of the Zunis did die last fall. As no accurate record of these events is kept among the Indians, it is impossible to verify the exact date, but as near as Mr. Cushing can learn, the death took place not far from the time at which Pa-lo-wah-te-wa declared it on the sandy shore of Manchester, with the sick man 2500 miles away.

GENERAL WASHINGTON NEWS.

TEXAS APPROPRIATIONS.

SPECIAL TO THE GAZETTE.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—The sundry civil bill carries the following amounts for completion of public buildings in Texas: For approaches and heating apparatus to courthouse and postoffice at Dallas, \$13,002; completion of building and approaches to and heating apparatus for custom house, postoffice and courthouse at El Paso, \$100,000; for continuation of custom house building at Galveston, \$65,000; heating apparatus for courthouse and postoffice at Tyler, \$4500; heating apparatus for courthouse and postoffice at Waco, \$7000.

NOT SIGNED BY THE PRESIDENT.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—The President has allowed the appropriation of \$400,000 per year to provide arms and equipments for militia to become a law without his signature, the constitutional limit of ten days within which he should have acted on this bill expired on Saturday. His failure to sign the bill is regarded as an oversight, as he was not known to object to any of its provisions.

SECRETARY MANNING RESIGNS.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—Secretary Manning called at the white house this afternoon and placed his resignation in the hands of the President, to take effect on the appointment and qualification of his successor. This action is taken in order to allow Mr. Manning to accept the presidency of the Western National Bank of the city of New York. His letter of resignation will not be made public for some days. It is stated at the White House that no immediate appointment will be made to the office, and that Mr. Manning will continue to act as Secretary for several weeks. It is known that the President parts with Mr. Manning with sincere regret and he reluctantly consents to his withdrawal from the cabinet. Secretary Manning left Washington this afternoon for Albany, via New York, accompanied by Mrs. Manning, Miss Manning and Mr. Robert L. Fryer.

A SUBSTITUTE BILL.

WASHINGTON, Feb. 14.—The subcommittee of the House committee on foreign affairs consisting of Messrs. Belmont, Clements and Rice, to-day presents its report on the retaliatory bills. A substitute bill is recommended for the Senate bill and Belmont bill.

It provides that when the President is satisfied American vessels are denied treaty rights for reasonable privileges, he may by proclamation prohibit entry into American ports of vessels owned wholly or in part by British subjects or arriving from Canada and New Foundland, except when in distress, and may forbid the importation of goods, wares or merchandise from Canada or New Foundland, on any locomotive, car or other vehicle. A violation of this provision is made punishable by fine and imprisonment. A section of the bill authorizes the creation of a commission to take testimony with respect to damages inflicted on American citizens and American vessels. The substitute bill was debated at length, but no action was taken.

The Old Cannon at Quebec.

LEWISTON (ME.) JOURNAL.

The best part of Mr. Atkinson's narrative was his dramatic story of his visit to the citadel.

"An officer" said he, "detailed a man to show me around, and he took me everywhere."

"Noticing a small black cannon, half hidden by the snow, as I was about to go, I said for fun: 'I guess I'll take it away with me!'"

"Go look at the inscription on the breech," said the soldier laughing.

"I looked and read: 'Taken at the battle of Bunker Hill, June 17, 1775.'"

"I saw the soldier had me. It stirred my blood and I wanted to make a fit reply. I read the inscription over again to gain time. Tears came to my eyes. 'Young man,' I said to him, 'you've got the cannon, but we've got Bunker Hill!'"

The patriotic soul of Maine turned red and actually cried again as he repeated the story.

A Candy "Pull" in London.

BOSTON POST.

An amusing story is told by a lady who has lived in London for a number of years and who wished to give some of her traveling companions a little entertainment of a characteristic sort. She therefore bade them assemble at her studio for a "candy pull," and lo, according to the summons, they came, but in the meantime their wretched hosts had been on a vain search for a gallon of molasses. It came very near being a candy party with the "pull" left out, when a brilliant British maid suggested that she try a paint shop. To the paint shop she went and came home in triumph with her jug of treacle.

Logical at Any Rate.

WASHINGTON CRITIC.

A little Virginia darkey named Cyrus had an older brother, Cassius, who had spent a winter in Washington in swell society, and when he returned home he set himself up as a teacher to his less cultured family. One day at the table Cyrus said to him:

"Gimme some 'lasses, Cass."

"You mustn't say 'lasses, Cy," corrected Cassius: "You must say mo-lasses."

"'Ligh!" granted Cyrus: "how's I gwine to say mo' lasses when I hain't had none yit?"

Had His Talk Out.

DETROIT FREE PRESS.

One of the veteran and best known of tug-men in this city had occasion to use the telephone and in the course of a discussion he was having with some one at the other end of the line he indulged in certain profane phrases with considerable emphasis. Accordingly he was cut off by the "Central" quite abruptly. Hanging up the phone the miner stepped into the next office, called up "Central" again and when he heard "Hello, what's wanted?" he said, "I simply wanted to say good-by."

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TWO INDIAN GHOSTS.

**A Lost Maiden and a Chief Who Leaped
from a Cliff.**

Ventura, Cal., Free Press.

The most weird story we have heard is told by two well known young men of this place, who were on a prospecting tour some three weeks since, near Cobblestone Mountain, at the northern boundary of this county. One cold night they were simultaneously awakened about 2 o'clock by the noise of crackling brush that had been thrown on the fire. They arose to a sitting posture and saw the figure of an Indian woman standing by the fire. She was dressed in a robe of gayly colored material that nearly reached her feet. A glistening necklace, evidently of gold and silver, enriched her neck and hanging pendant from this was a number of bears' claws. Her black hair reached below her waist. In her ears were large hoop earrings of gold.

Upon seeing the form one of the young men instinctively reached for his rifle by his side. When the figure saw the motion

men instinctively reached for his rifle by his side. When the figure saw the motion she motioned for him not to fire and moved down the trail, beckoning to them. Before disappearing from view she again beckoned, but they were too dumfounded to follow. The next morning they followed the trail, and after much difficulty traced the footprints to the base of a high cliff about a mile from their camp. The rest of the story told is to this effect: "The next morning we discussed the matter and determined to investigate. So the next night we took our blankets and went to the base of the cliff. At about midnight, the same hour, the figure appeared to us; we saw a bright phosphorescent light on the brow of the cliff, and I am sure we heard a voice calling "Meeneeah! Meeneeah!"

An old Indian tradition is to the effect that many, many years ago an Indian maiden—Meeneeah, the only daughter of a chief—was lost in this region and starved to death near the place called Squaw Flat. It is said that many camping parties have seen the phosphorescent light spoken of in the vicinity where these young men were camped.
